First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: 8 AM to 11 AM weekdays.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: T-W-F, 9am-12pm
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Toni Gray

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

March 19, 2023

10am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Erin Grainger, Music and Choral Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Sue Powers, Administrative Assistant
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS:
"Never doubt that a small group of thoughtful, committed citizens can change the world; indeed, it is the only thing that has ever happened." –Margaret Mead

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE *Молитва За Україну* Ukrainian Anthem

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

SUNG CALL TO WORSHIP

Let your Spirit come, **Let your Spirit come,**
fall upon me now, **fall upon me now.**
Let your Spirit come, **Let your Spirit come**
fall upon us now, **fall upon us now,**

Let your rain fall down, **Let your rain fall down**
pour upon our souls, **pour upon our souls**
Come and wash us now, **Come and wash us now,**
come and make us whole, **come and make us whole.**

Let your Spirit come, **Let your Spirit come,**
fall upon me now, **fall upon me now.**
Let your Spirit come, **Let your Spirit come**
fall upon us now, **fall upon us now.**

WELCOME TO ALL VISITORS: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]FROM UCC WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- First Congregational Church of St Albans
- Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- Our local Girl Scout Troop
- As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- F/GI Community Action
- Voices Against Violence
- Samaritan House
- Restorative Justice Center
- Pathways

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

MORNING PRAYER[1] **(UNISON)**

Anointed One, your love comes peaceably into our lives if we will but let it. We are so fixated on the gold standard, the familiar, and the safe choice that we often lose sight of what you are raising up right in our very midst. Enliven us with your Spirit this day so that we might get a glimpse of your peace. Take what we might imagine as too small for your kindom and use it to open the world to your overflowing abundance and provision for all that you have created. In the name of Jesus the Christ we pray. Amen

HYMN*

"There Is a Wideness in God's Mercy" NCH 23

PRAYER OF CONFESSION[1] **(UNISON)**

God of surprises, we know that we do not often perceive the world as you do. We look to the flashy fame, the grand gestures, optimal achievements, and unreachable standards. Yet, in spite of our misguided reach towards perfection, you give us glimpses of your grandeur and grace. Surprise us yet again this day, O God, that in our complacency which allows us to drift towards the same old ways of faith that we may be transformed anew. Provide us with a new cup of oil that we may be anointed by your love so that we may set out into your world to bless and anoint others. In the name of the One whose love and peace make all things new we pray. Amen

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

TIME WITH CHILDREN

ANTHEM Brother James' Air
- James Leith Macbeth Bain, arr. M. Wilberg

SCRIPTURE READING
JOHN 9:1-41

MORNING REFLECTION: ***WIDE EYED***

HYMN*
"Amazing Grace" (1, 3, 5) NCH 547

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

CHORAL CALL TO PRAYER:
HEAR OUR PRAYER, O LORD D. Welpton

PRAYER OF THE PEOPLE ~

LORD'S PRAYER

Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

CHORAL RESPONSE TO PRAYER
"THOU WILT KEEP HIM IN PERFECT PEACE, WHOSE MIND IS STAYED ON THEE." SCOTTISH PSALTER, 1615

THE DEPARTURE

HYMN*
"We Are Marching" NCH 526

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE
Londonderry Air Irish Folk Song

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Greg Beeman Thank You for organizing another amazing Open Mic night!
- Joel Magnuson Thank You for providing hospitality for the open mic!
- Sue Brown Thank You for you ministry of the Woman's Fellowship Breakfast!
- Mara Vijups Thank You for your floral ministry—your beautiful arrangements really light-up the altar!

Bible Study
Our next Bible Study will meet on March 22
Fellowship 6:45pm; Bible Study 7:00- 8:00pm
Text: John 11:1-45

Outreach Think-Tank
Saturday March 25th 2:00pm- 4:00pm
We'll be reviewing 2022's outreach efforts and planning 2023 outreach. Everyone is welcome!

Music Notes: This morning's anthem is the text to Psalm 23, also known as "The Lord's My Shepherd". The original composer was a Scottish hymn writer, religious minister and author who became known to his peers
as Brother James (hence the title "Brother James' Air").